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Glossary

avenue	–	a wide street
habitual	–	regular
nigh	–	almost
twirling	–	twisting and spinning around
intricate	–	complicated
stalwart	–	physically strong
swagger	–	walk in a confident way
vicinity	–	the surrounding area (neighbourhood)
reassuringly	–	making someone feel less doubtful
proposition	–	theory or system
plodder	–	one who toils slowly but steadily
wits	–	intelligent people
groove	–	a dull routine that does not change
razor-edge	–	a critical situation
dismally	–	without happiness and cheer
absurdity	–	quality of being silly and foolish
egotism	–	a feeling of self-im portance
outline	–	describe
wires	–	sends a telegraphic message

1. Answer the following questions in a sentence or two each, based on your understanding of the story.

a) Describe the appearance of the policeman on the beat.

b) What did he keep doing while on his rounds?

c) Why were the streets devoid of people?

d) What story did the man standing near the hardware store tell the passing cop?

e) What used to be there in the place of that shop twenty years ago?

f) Describe the man awaiting the arrival of his friend.

g) Why did the friends part ways?

h) When and how did Bob realise that the tall man was not his friend?

i) Who was the tall man?

k) What did he give Bob?

2. State whether the following statements are true or false

a) The cop suddenly slowed his walk, when he heard the barking of dogs.

b) The friends grew up together in the city of New York.

c) Both Jimmy and Bob were of the same age.

d) The friends parted one night after watching a movie together.

e) The friends could not keep in touch because they lost each other's phone numbers.